



Gavin Newsom, Governor
State of California
Health and Human Services Agency
DEPARTMENT OF MANAGED HEALTH CARE
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March 9, 2026

VIA ELECTRONIC MAIL

Lea Ann Tonkin
Cigna HealthCare of California, Inc.
400 N. Brand Blvd. Suite 400
Glendale, CA 91203

Re: Proposed Contract Termination with UCSD Medical Group
Block Transfer Filing No. 2026-PROV-95
Filed on March 5, 2026

Dear Ms. Tonkin:

The Department of Managed Health Care (Department) is reviewing the information in the above-referenced Block Transfer Filing (Filing) submitted by **Cigna HealthCare of California, Inc.** (Plan) for compliance with the requirements of the Knox-Keene Health Care Service Plan Act of 1975, as amended (Cal. Health & Safety Code § 1340 *et seq.*) and the regulations promulgated thereunder (Cal. Code Regs., Tit. 28, § 1000 *et seq.*).

In the event of contract termination, the Filing proposes to remove **UCSD Medical Group** (Terminating Provider Group) from the Plan's provider network. The effective date of contract termination between the Terminating Provider Group and the Plan (Termination Date) is currently **July 1, 2026**.

Please review the following comments and feel free to contact me if you would like to discuss any of the issues before filing the Plan's response.

1. Please confirm whether the provider group termination is part of a health system termination. If yes, please confirm the health system and whether the contract is a stand-alone contract.
2. Regarding the Enrollee Transfer Notice submitted for this Filing, the following information was found missing. Please resubmit the Enrollee Transfer Notice for the Department's review to include the following:
 - a. Statement informing enrollees that they may contact the Plan for language assistance. This statement must include contact information.

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3. Please confirm whether the contract termination between the Plan and UCSD Medical Group impacts Point of Service (POS) enrollees.
4. Please confirm whether the Receiving Provider Group(s) have admitting privileges to an in-network hospital.
5. Please provide the following for each proposed Receiving Provider Group:
 - a. Contract termination date,
 - b. In the case of an evergreen contract with any proposed Receiving Provider Group, please provide the Department with:
 - i. Contract renewal date(s), or
 - ii. If there is no specified renewal date(s), please state whether a notice of termination has been sent or received, and
 - iii. Confirm whether each evergreen contract will automatically renew.
6. To assess the Block Transfer's impact on the Plan's specialist network, please provide or confirm:
 - a. Each Receiving Provider Group has the necessary providers to deliver the full scope of specialty services required under the Plan's contract with its enrollees,
 - b. Any specialties available within the Terminating Provider Group that would not be available within any of the Receiving Provider Groups,
 - i. For any specialties no longer available to affected enrollees as a result of the proposed transition, please explain how those enrollees will continue to access such specialty services,
 - c. The name and contact information for each Receiving Provider Group responding to this issue.
7. To assess the Block Transfer's impact on the Plan's hospital network, please provide or confirm:
 - a. Whether the Plan has sent or received a notice of contract termination from any of the Receiving Provider Groups' primary hospitals, and if so, whether that contract is set to terminate within the next six months,
 - b. Any inpatient or outpatient hospital-based services available to affected enrollees through the Terminating Provider Group that would not be available through any of the Receiving Provider Groups,
 - i. For any hospital-based services no longer available to affected enrollees as a result of the proposed transition, please explain how enrollees will continue to access such services.
8. To assess continuity of care for enrollees affected by the Block Transfer, please identify or confirm:

- a. The number of affected enrollees who have been authorized or approved to receive a procedure or service from a provider within the Terminating Provider Group within 180 days of the Termination Date,
 - b. The number of affected enrollees who have been authorized or approved to receive a procedure or service within 180 days of the Termination Date from a hospital utilized by the Terminating Provider Group, but not utilized by the enrollee's Receiving Provider Group,
 - c. Whether a continuity of care and/or completion of covered services agreement exists between the Plan and the Terminating Provider Group. If no agreement exists, please provide an update on the progress, if any, of reaching an agreement.
9. Please indicate whether the Plan intends to send an Enrollee Notice to all Plan enrollees assigned to **UCSD Medical Group**.

Please submit the Plan's response by **March 16, 2026**, via the Block Transfer portal as a "Response to Comment Letter."

Please contact me if there are any questions regarding the above.

Regards,



Nune Mikayelyan
Analyst II
Office of Plan Monitoring